

# Structural Clarity: Executive Report

What this run measured, what the result may mean, what remains uncertain, and what to test next.

## EXECUTIVE REPORT

Sample report · Example data

**52** **DIAGNOSTIC SCORE**  
Heavy

| SAMPLE<br>CREATED     | INSTRUMENT         | SCOPE      |
|-----------------------|--------------------|------------|
| September 13,<br>2026 | Structural Clarity | Operations |

Main measured focus for Supplier onboarding: Clarity about who is accountable.

## Interpretation and next steps

The reported difficulty centres on accountability: the participant says unclarity most often starts with who answers when things go wrong, and that such cases are frequently escalated and take time to resolve. Roles are reported as defined but interpreted differently by different people, with meaningful overlap that creates gaps or duplicated work. The suggested next steps are to review specific available examples of unclear accountability and of one work boundary; all of this is one participant's account rather than independently observed practice.

Supporting evidence: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5. See the evidence register.

## Important context from the saved result

- Not measured: Approval duplication. No score is available for this dimension. Related answers may still be reported separately.

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## What the evidence shows

These findings distinguish scored results from what participants reported.

In this Structural Clarity run, the participant reports that when roles, responsibilities or working arrangements are unclear in this area, the problem most often starts with accountability, meaning it is unclear who answers when things go wrong. Whether the formal structure shows who is accountable when something goes wrong is reported to depend on the situation, clear in some cases and not others. Shared accountability is reported as shared in ways that risk leaving gaps, and unclear accountability is reported as frequently escalated, taking time to resolve.

Supporting evidence: 1, 6, 7, 4. See the evidence register.

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Roles are reported as defined but interpreted differently by different people, and people sometimes have to ask who is responsible for a piece of work rather than seeing it without asking. The participant also reports meaningful overlap of responsibilities that creates gaps or duplicated work, and handoff points between teams or functions that are known informally but not formally stated. These are separate reported conditions and can coexist.

Supporting evidence: 2, 8, 3, 9. See the evidence register.

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On decision authority, the participant reports that who can decide what depends on the situation and who applies pressure, and that the limits of authority are unclear at the edges and require judgment calls. Asked whether decisions are consistently made at the appropriate level, the answer is inconsistent, depending on context or individuals. That answer concerns the level at which decisions are made, not the general consistency or quality of decisions.

Supporting evidence: 10, 11, 12. See the evidence register.

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### **Reported experience**

Managers · Structural Clarity

Scope: This participant's reported work

“Participant's own experience: Routine suppliers usually have a clear owner and the checklist is followed. Exceptions are less clear: the requesting manager expects procurement to decide, while procurement sometimes sends the decision back. Some team members say ownership is clear in practice, so I would compare actual exception cases before changing responsibilities. My recent examples include both routine requests and exceptions.”

A useful check would be to compare recent routine requests with recent exception cases and record, for each, who made or returned the decision and on what stated basis, without assuming in advance which pattern holds.

Supporting evidence: 13. See the evidence register.

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## **What may explain it**

Possible explanations to investigate, not established causes.

The participant describes the unit as a shared-service function supporting multiple internal clients and reports frequent change to its structure over the past year, with the structure still catching up. Recent change may be one reason roles are reported as defined but interpreted differently by different people; the evidence does not establish this. It could be examined by checking, where the relevant part of the structure is available, whether responsibilities changed during the past year and, if so, which of them remain unclear.

Supporting evidence: 14, 15, 2. See the evidence register.

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## Practical next steps

Start with these practical checks or focused changes.

### For all next steps

#### Before trying it

Obtain permission and access before the review. If either is unavailable, stop. Process changes need separate approval.

#### Risk to consider

An isolated example may not represent normal work; do not generalize its findings.

### Next step 1

**If an example is available in the assessed unit where it was unclear who answers when something went wrong, review that example to establish who is accountable for the outcome, or why that accountability cannot be established.**

The participant reports that unclarity in this area most often starts with accountability for things going wrong, and that unclear accountability is frequently escalated and takes time to resolve, so a single concrete case is the direct way to test what can be established. Federal internal control guidance recommends assigning responsibility and authority clearly; applying it in a professional services setting is a proposed adaptation, not a compliance conclusion.

Supporting evidence: 1, 4. See the evidence register. Practice sources: 1. See Research and sector context.

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#### How to judge the test

Record whether an example was available. Record who is accountable for the reviewed outcome, or why that accountability could not be established. Note anything unresolved or contrary to the concern.

## Next step 2

**If a relevant example is available, review it to identify where responsibility starts and ends on each side of the work boundary.**

The participant reports meaningful overlap of responsibilities that creates gaps or duplicated work, and that people sometimes have to ask who is responsible for a piece of work. Examining one boundary shows whether the overlap is deliberate or leaves an unassigned step.

Supporting evidence: 8, 3. See the evidence register.

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### How to judge the test

Record where responsibility starts and ends on each side, including any gap or overlap found. Note anything unresolved or contrary to the concern.

## Next step 3

**If an example of uncertainty about accountability is available, review it to establish how that uncertainty was resolved, or why it remained unresolved.**

Unclear accountability is reported as frequently escalated and taking time to resolve, and shared accountability is reported as shared in ways that risk leaving gaps. Tracing one case shows what actually settled the question.

Supporting evidence: 7, 4. See the evidence register.

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### How to judge the test

Record how the uncertainty about accountability was resolved, or why it remained unresolved. Note anything unresolved or contrary to the concern.

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## What this report cannot establish

Responses describe one participant's view. More questions do not establish greater validity.

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Missing evidence is unknown, not a favorable result.

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Scores do not establish causation, predict later performance or prove realized savings.

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Organizational exposure, projected recovery and return on investment are withheld for a single run. A participant's recorded time answer is not organizational savings.

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Instrument design-reference ranges are not empirical sector benchmarks.

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Names may remain in participant text after best-effort minimization. Observations about other roles remain this participant's account.

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## Supporting evidence register

Each item is listed once. Numbers beside findings and actions refer to these saved values or attributed observations.

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### 1. When roles, responsibilities, or working arrangements are unclear in this area, where does the problem most often start?

Accountability: unclear who answers when things go wrong

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### 2. How clearly are roles defined? Can people see who does what in the formal structure, or do they rely on informal knowledge?

Defined but interpreted differently by different people

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### 3. How much do responsibilities overlap, or have unclear boundaries, across people or teams in this structure?

Meaningful overlap: creates gaps or duplicated work

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### 4. When accountability is unclear, how is it typically resolved?

Frequently escalated: takes time to resolve

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**5. Participant observation - Managerial**

Participant's own experience: Routine suppliers usually have a clear owner and the checklist is followed. Exceptions are less clear: the requesting manager expects procurement to decide, while procurement sometimes sends the decision back. Some team members say ownership is clear in practice, so I would compare actual exception cases before changing responsibilities. My recent examples include both routine requests and exceptions.

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**7. When accountability is shared, does it remain clear, or does sharing it make it effectively unclear?**

Shared in ways that risk leaving gaps

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**9. How clear are handoff points between teams or functions? Are the boundaries defined in the formal structure, or learned informally?**

Known informally but not formally stated

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**11. Do people know the limits of their authority, or do they discover them by testing them?**

Unclear at the edges: requires judgment calls

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**6. When something goes wrong, is it clear from the formal structure who is accountable, or must that be established each time?**

Depends on the situation: clear in some cases, not others

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**8. Can people usually tell who is responsible for a piece of work without asking or relying on personal knowledge?**

Sometimes have to ask

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**10. How clear is it who can decide what? Do people know, or must they infer it from behavior and past decisions?**

Depends on the situation and who applies pressure

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**12. Are decisions consistently made at the appropriate level, or does this depend on who is available or who applies pressure?**

Inconsistent: depends on context or individuals

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**13. Participant observation · Managerial**

Participant's own experience: Routine suppliers usually have a clear owner and the checklist is followed. Exceptions are less clear: the requesting manager expects procurement to decide, while procurement sometimes sends the decision back. Some team members say ownership is clear in practice, so I would compare actual exception cases before changing responsibilities. My recent examples include both routine requests and exceptions.

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**14. Which best describes the team, group, or function you are assessing?**

A shared-service function (supporting multiple internal clients)

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**15. Which best describes changes to the structure of this unit over the past year?**

Frequent change, with the structure still catching up

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**Research and sector context**

No newly checked public-source research is included. Any listed practice sources are dated references, not a current sector benchmark.

The reviewed sources do not supply a comparable sector distribution for this diagnostic. No sector percentile or numerical peer estimate is available.

1. [Standards for Internal Control in the Federal Government](#) · U.S. Government Accountability Office · Published 2025-05-15 · Checked 2026-09-08
2. [Sharing the Care Plan: Brief](#) · Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality · Checked 2026-09-08
3. [About the Baldrige Excellence Framework](#) · National Institute of Standards and Technology · Checked 2026-09-08

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### How Monderman produced this interpretation

Monderman's diagnostic engine produces the scores and determines which findings and recommendations the evidence supports. AI contributes research and explanation within those rules. Automated checks and a separate AI review check the interpretation against its supporting evidence before publication.

Prepared 2026-09-13T21:10:51.581Z. Report version monderman-interpretation-20260913.38. This report preserves the evidence and research used when it was prepared.

# Main measured focus for Supplier onboarding: Clarity about who is accountable.

DIAGNOSTIC SCORE

52  
HEAVY

This structure received a clarity score of 52 in the heavy band. The measured issues are distributed, and Accountability clarity is the first one to examine.

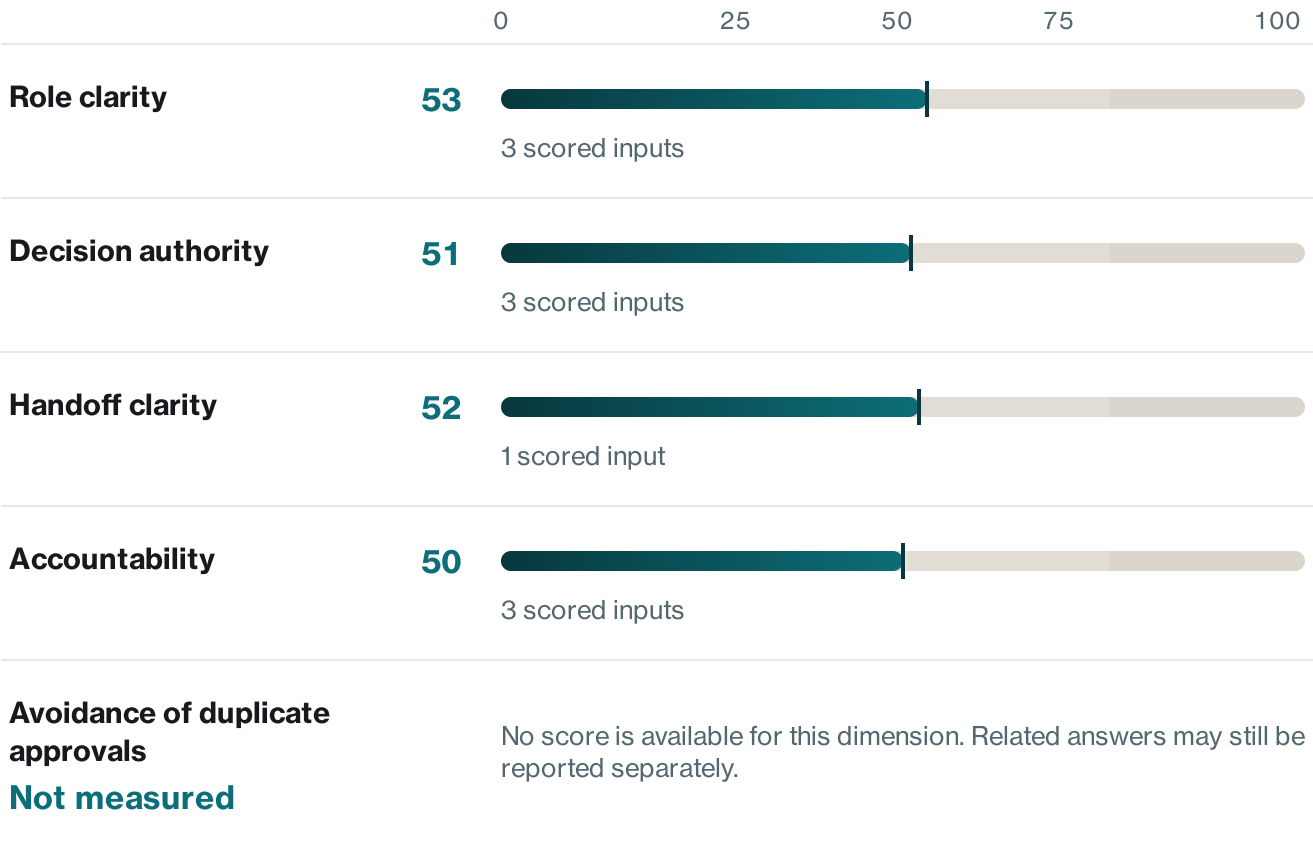
| PRIMARY MEASURED FOCUS                                                                                                                                            | PARTICIPANT PERSPECTIVE                             | CHANGE OVER TIME                   | EVIDENCE DEPTH                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Clarity about who is accountable</b><br><br>The score indicates mixed clarity about accountability for outcomes. Review who is accountable in a specific case. | <b>Managerial</b><br><br>One person's recorded view | <b>Not established by this run</b> | <b>Narrow, directional read</b><br><br>Managerial perspective |

WHAT THIS MAY MEAN

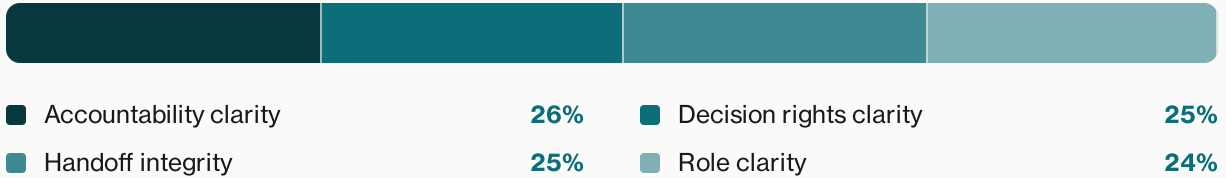
Start with one clear statement of Accountability clarity. Observe whether people can identify ownership and authority without asking for informal help.

# Dimension profile

The profile keeps the total score and its contributing dimensions visible together. For condition dimensions, lower values indicate greater measured constraint. For Compensatory Effort, when shown, higher values indicate more reported extra effort.



## CLARITY INDICATOR DISTRIBUTION



### PATTERN ACROSS DIMENSIONS

**Mixed**

The chart compares each dimension's distance from the top of the scoring scale. Shares do not measure hours, cost, or risk, and do not by themselves establish a problem.

### FINDINGS FROM SCORED ANSWERS

- The decision-authority score is in the lower measured range. Check the stated authority in a specific case.
- The handoff-clarity score is in the lower measured range. Check responsibilities at a specific transfer of work; a breakdown is not established.
- The accountability-clarity score is in the lower measured range. Check who is accountable in a specific case; an ownership gap is not established.

## What the result supports and what it does not

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### DESIGN REFERENCE (NOT A PEER BENCHMARK)

This score sits below Monderman's design reference range for shared service function. The reference is an instrument calibration, not a sampled peer benchmark. It does not distinguish a design issue from a communication issue. Compare the recorded answers and relevant work examples before proposing an explanation.

### TRADEOFF TO CONSIDER

Some ambiguity may preserve useful discretion. Test whether added clarity reduces avoidable interpretation without removing flexibility the work needs.

### RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE MEASURED DIMENSIONS

Structural legibility was measured, but governance weight was not covered in this run. The score therefore excludes governance rather than treating an unanswered dimension as either healthy or burdensome. A longer run can locate the result on both axes. This score-based classification indicates lower reported clarity. Check the stated ownership, authority and handoffs before deciding whether a change is needed.

### CHANGE OVER TIME

**Not established by this run**

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What this result is based on

|                                                                                              |                                                                               |                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>EVIDENCE DEPTH</p> <p><b>Narrow, directional read</b></p> <p>Scope of this single run</p> | <p>MEASURED DIMENSIONS</p> <p><b>4 of 5</b></p> <p>Dimensions represented</p> | <p>PERSPECTIVE</p> <p><b>Managerial</b></p> <p>Notes do not change the score</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

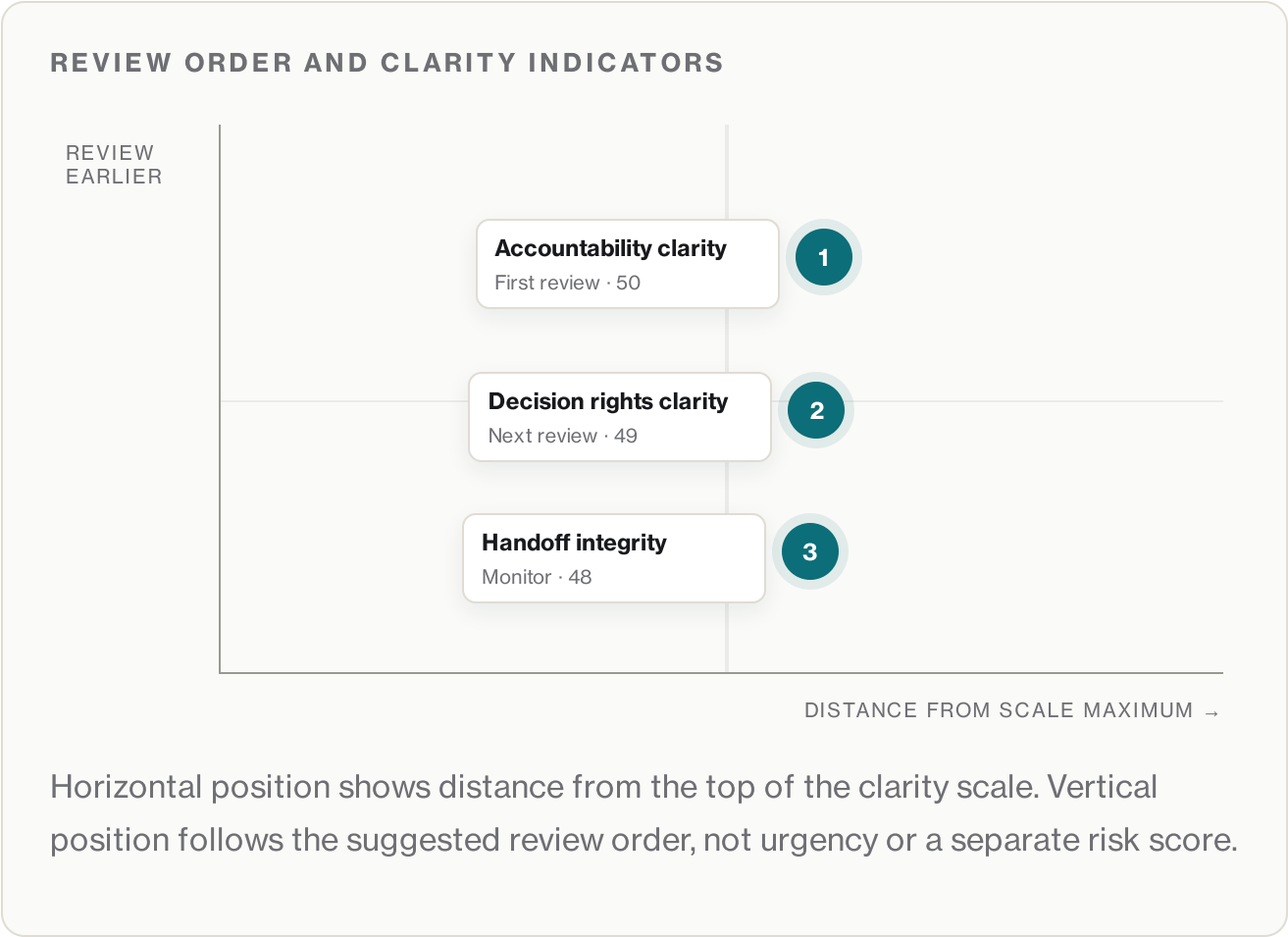
MANAGERIAL

Routine suppliers usually have a clear owner and the checklist is followed. Exceptions are less clear: the requesting manager expects procurement to decide, while procurement sometimes sends the decision back. Some team members say ownership is clear in practice, so I would compare actual exception cases before changing responsibilities. My recent examples include both routine requests and exceptions.

WATCH ITEMS

No additional watch item was recorded for this run.

# Measured priorities



|    |                                                      |    |
|----|------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 01 | <b>FIRST REVIEW</b><br><b>Accountability clarity</b> | 50 |
| 02 | <b>NEXT REVIEW</b><br><b>Decision rights clarity</b> | 49 |
| 03 | <b>MONITOR</b><br><b>Handoff integrity</b>           | 48 |

# How this report was produced

|                               |                                                                           |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| INSTRUMENT                    | Structural Clarity                                                        |
| OPERATING SCOPE               | Supplier onboarding                                                       |
| PARTICIPANT PERSPECTIVE       | Managerial                                                                |
| REPORTED ANSWER<br>CONFIDENCE | Moderate                                                                  |
| CHANGE OVER TIME              | Not established by this run                                               |
| QUESTIONNAIRE VERSION         | 1.3.0                                                                     |
| SCORING VERSION               | Structural Clarity scoring method, methodology version 4, August 11, 2026 |
| REPORT WORDING VERSION        | diagnostic-report-language-20260911.1                                     |
| CURRENT DISPLAY VERSION       | diagnostic-renderer-evidence-reading-20260914.43                          |
| ENGINE REVISION               | 9a507d87df8b56f6613304d1fbad44ce52f833d6                                  |

The score and dimension values come from the submitted answers. Participant notes, when present, are shown separately and do not change the score. One run does not establish organizational savings or recoverable time. The design reference was set when the instrument was designed; it is not a comparison with customer or industry data.

## INTERPRETATION BOUNDARY

This report is based on one participant's answers for the stated scope. It identifies dimensions to compare and checks to consider; a comparison alone does not establish a need for change. It does not show how common these conditions are, prove their causes or predict performance. Organizational time and money estimates require separate operational measurements beyond a single run.